Delegation Board

Make decision rights explicit: for each area, agree how much the team decides, and move it up over time.

Lead the Organisation · Inspired by Management 3.0 (Jurgen Appelo) · Seven Levels of Delegation

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

LEADER: Head of Digital

Seven Levels of Delegation

FROM LEADER DECIDES TO TEAM DECIDES

1 **Tell**	2 **Sell**	3 **Consult**	4 **Agree**	5 **Advise**	6 **Inquire**	7 **Delegate**
I decide and tell you	*I decide and explain why*	*I ask you, then I decide*	*We decide together*	*I advise, you decide*	*You decide, then tell me*	*You decide; no need to tell me*

1 Decision Areas

MARK TODAY'S LEVEL · ARROW TO WHERE WE'RE HEADING

DECISION AREA	1 · TELL	2 · SELL	3 · CONSULT	4 · AGREE	5 · ADVISE	6 · INQUIRE	7 · DELEGATE	REVIEW BY
Hiring into the team			● →	○				Q3
Tools and technology					● →	○		Q3
How we plan our work						● →	○	June
Working hours						●		–
Spending up to £2k			● →		○			July
Architecture choices					● →	○		Q3
Who works on what							●	–
Release timing				● →		○		June

2 Guardrails

LIMITS THAT ALWAYS APPLY

e.g. budget limits, legal and policy rules, security standards

Spending over £2k needs Finance sign-off · customer data stays in the UK and EU

Accessibility (WCAG AA) and security reviews always apply

3 Next Steps

- [x] Agreed with the team, not just announced
- [x] Posted where everyone can see it
- [x] One area moves up a level next
- [ ] Review the board every few months

Next to move: spending (3 → 5), from July

"Which decisions could the team make without us?"

"What would we need to trust to move this up one level?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working